

High-chance portions — polity-const

Combined original study articles for this topic's highest-probability PYQ themes.

Fundamental Rights, DPSPs & Their Interplay

~48% · FR articles · DPSP · Reasonable restrictions · Harmony doctrine

Articles, restrictions, enforceability contrasts and landmark harmony doctrine.

Why UPSC asks this

Constitutional rights are the densest Prelims polity block every year.

FR map for speed

Group rights: equality, freedom, exploitation (23–24), religion, culture–education (29–30), constitutional remedies. Know which are available to citizens vs persons. Art 32 as “heart and soul” (Ambedkar) still appears.

Restrictions & exceptions

Art 19 reasonable restrictions grounds; Art 21 expanded jurisprudence (education, privacy — landmark awareness). Emergency effects historically important.

DPSP & interplay

Socialistic, Gandhian, liberal–intellectual principles classification helps memory. Conflict with FRs resolved toward harmonious construction in later doctrine — classic statement area.

Must remember

- Art 14–18 equality; 19 freedoms; 20–22 criminal process & life/liberty; 25–28 religion; 32 constitutional remedies
- DPSP Part IV non-justiciable but fundamental in governance
- Minerva Mills — harmony of FR & DPSP

Amendment Procedure & Basic Structure

~45% · Art 368 · Basic structure · Judicial review

Article 368 pathways and Kesavananda doctrine — perennial high-weight theme.

Why UPSC asks this

Tests understanding of constitutional change limits — conceptual, not rote article spam.

How amendment works

Simple special majority; some provisions need state ratification (federal features). Know that amendment is not unlimited legislative power.

Basic structure

Court identifies essentials that Parliament cannot destroy via 368. List illustrative features; remember doctrine evolved through Indira Gandhi election case, Minerva Mills, etc.

Must remember

- Kesavananda Bharati (1973) — basic structure
- Examples often cited: supremacy of Constitution, judicial review, federalism, secularism, free & fair elections
- 42nd/44th amendments political context